TAP Monthly Newsletter

APRIL-2025



3RD APRIL

Donation of PPE Kits to TB Hospital

Objective:
To donate unused COVID-era Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) kits to a public hospital in need, ensuring their responsible use and extending support to the healthcare system.

Program Details:

- TAP received PPE kits during the COVID-19 pandemic from external donors.
- As the kits remained unused and in good condition, TAP decided to donate them where they could still be impactful.
- The Government TB Hospital, Visakhapatnam, was identified as the recipient due to their continued need for protective gear.

Impact:

- Enhanced infection control and safety for hospital staff working in high-risk TB wards.
- Promoted ethical redistribution of surplus medical supplies.
- Reinforced TAP's commitment to public health partnerships and effective community support.



APRIL 12

Spinal Cord Injury Rehabilitation – APD Partnership Field Visit

From April 12th to 16th, The Ability People (TAP) conducted a field visit in Andhra Pradesh to explore collaboration with APD Bangalore for establishing a comprehensive spinal cord injury rehabilitation programme. The visit focused on assessing the feasibility of implementing the 'Cot-to-Community' model, which aims to provide holistic, home-based rehabilitation services to socio-economically vulnerable individuals with spinal cord injuries and other disabilities.

Key services planned under this initiative include:

- Physiotherapy, occupational therapy & mobility training
- Pressure sore, bladder & bowel management
- Psychological counselling & peer support
- Assistive technology and wheelchair assessment
- Livelihood support & seed funding for micro-enterprises
- Advocacy for disability rights and access to schemes
- This partnership aims to expand services across rural and tribal regions of coastal Andhra Pradesh. Discussions are ongoing regarding the use of VIMS premises for service delivery. The collaboration is set to bring impactful change in rehabilitation access and community reintegration for PwDs in the region.





Participation in World Autism Awareness Day Celebrations

- On April 5th, our NGO The Ability People actively participated in the World Autism Awareness Day celebrations. A group of 30 children under our care took part in the event, which aimed to promote understanding, inclusion, and support for individuals with autism. The celebration provided a meaningful platform for our children to engage in various awareness activities, interact with the community, and express their talents. Our participation reflected our ongoing commitment to creating an inclusive society and advocating for the rights and needs of individuals with developmental disabilities.



Coordination Meeting on Spinal Cord Injury Rehabilitation Centre

Objective:
To discuss and propose the establishment of a dedicated Spinal Cord Injury (SCI) Rehabilitation Centre in Alluri Sitharama Raju (ASR) District, aiming to support long-term recovery and social reintegration for individuals living with spinal cord injuries.

Key Highlights of the Meeting:

- Participation:
- The meeting was attended by government officials, NGO representatives, healthcare professionals, and community leaders to collectively address the gaps in SCI rehabilitation services in rural and tribal regions.
- **Key Discussion Points:**
- Challenges faced by SCI patients, including permanent disabilities and socio-economic setbacks.
- Inaccessibility of rehabilitation, lack of assistive devices, and limited livelihood support in rural areas.



05 May 2025

- **TAP requested district-level support on:**
- Identification and medical assessment of SCI individuals.
- Provision of assistive devices (wheelchairs, cushions, walkers).
- Establishing a district-level Rehabilitation Centre with local partnerships.
- Vocational training and livelihood integration.
- Organizing medical outreach and awareness camps to prevent secondary complications.
- **District Collector's Response & Assurances:**

- The District Collector acknowledged TAP's efforts and recognized their work in empowering persons with disabilities.

- **Issued a directive to district departments to:**
- Allocate space within government premises for the rehabilitation centre.
- Provide the necessary approvals, facilities, and inter-departmental coordination to support the initiative.
- Emphasized a collaborative approach towards building an inclusive and compassionate society.

the ability people
The wind beneath your wheels

Project Planning & Management Workshop (Apr 21–23)



TAP staff participated in a 3-day PPM training at YES J Centre, Vijayawada. The training enhanced project design, M&E skills, and NGO collaboration capacity.
Dates: 21st – 23rd April 2025
Venue: YES J Centre for Excellence, Vijayawada
Facilitators: Mr. Giri Garu and Mrs. Rohini Ravindra
Organized by: Dhwani Foundation – Niranthara Sahayak Program
bjectives:

- Build capacity in effective program planning.
- Introduce Logical Framework Approach and Monitoring & Evaluation concepts.

Ramp Installation in TAP Van (Apr 23)



Objective:
To enhance the accessibility and mobility of the TAP Rehabilitation Van by installing a ramp, enabling more inclusive and mobile service delivery for persons with disabilities.

A **hydraulic ramp** was installed in TAP's rehab van to provide **easy access for wheelchair users and persons with limited mobility**.
This van will be deployed for **Mobile Rehabilitation Services**, especially in **rural and tribal areas** where access to physical therapy and assistive devices is limited.
The van will be used in **summer camps, community outreach programs, health camps**, and **home-based services**, providing:

- Physiotherapy
- Assistive device distribution
- On-spot assessments
- Disability screenings and referrals

Apr 30



Child Protection Awareness Program (Apr 30)
Objective:
The primary objective of this program was to raise awareness about child abuse and promote child rights protection among caregivers, staff, and the broader community.
Participants:

- Staff from the hosting organization
- Members of SWANTHANA and CRPF
- Children and caregivers from the rehabilitation center
- Total participation: Approximately 20–25 individuals including adults and children

ey Activities:

- Display of placards with impactful messages advocating for child rights and protection.
- Group participation in photo sessions to disseminate the awareness message.
- Highlighted messages in Telugu and English included:
  - "STOP Child Abuse"
  - "Children deserve a safe and nurturing environment"
  - "Protect Children, Protect the Nation"
  - "Let's empower children to live with dignity"
  - "Give children a voice,

Outcomes:

- Increased awareness among participants on the significance of child protection.
- Strengthened advocacy against child abuse through visual campaigns.
- Reinforced community commitment to safeguarding children's rights.



Beneficiaries Attended – April 2025

Program: Physiotherapy and Early Intervention Support
During the month of April 2025, the physiotherapy team provided assessment and treatment to the following 27 children and young individuals presenting with various neurological, orthopedic, and developmental conditions:



Assistive Devices Delivered – April 2025

Paid Devices:
- 6 AFOs, 3 KAFOs, 2 Insoles, 2 Shoe Modifications, 1 Hip Abduction Orthosis

Free Devices:
- 6 AFOs, 1 Boston Brace
- (Beneficiaries: Reshma, Jayavardhan, Sohita, Puneeth)

Devices Ready for Delivery:
- 6 KAFOs, 6 AFOs
- (Prepared for: Guna Vardhan, Mokshith Reddy, Suraj, etc.)

Device Allocation for Patients

S. No	Name	Device(s) Provided
1	G. Satwik	B/L AFO & B/L KAFO
2	Sankili Das	Lt Insole
3	P. Jagadesh	Lt Insole
4	Ashnat Khan	Lt KAFO
5	Vinil Kumar	B/L AFO
6	K. Ashmita	B/L AFO
7	Anusha	Lt Hip Abduction Orthosis
8	S. Preetam	B/L Shoe Modification

UPCOMING PROGRAMS

Ability Vehicle Launch - Coming This May!

We are excited to launch our Ability Vehicle, an accessible electric rickshaw designed exclusively for individuals with disabilities. This initiative by us ensures safe, comfortable, and independent travel. Join us for the official launch this May!

One-Week Summer Camp for Children's

We're hosting a One-Week Summer Camp for children with mild to moderate disabilities. This program, tailored for individuals with disabilities, will run from morning to evening, offering fun outings, activities, and free doctor consultations. Register now for a memorable experience!

Mother's Day Celebration for Mothers with Disabilities

Celebrate Mother's Day with us! Our Mother's Day Celebration is dedicated to mothers with disabilities, featuring special activities, entertainment, and a chance to connect with others. Join us for a day of joy and recognition.

Nutrition Program for People with Disabilities

Our Nutrition Program is designed exclusively for individuals with disabilities, providing guidance on balanced diets, access to nutritious meals, and expert advice to support health and wellness. Stay tuned for more details on how to participate!